

Tue, Dec 06, 2022 9:15AM • 1:06:14

Therapist 00:00

But all you know, okay, I will just ask my husband darling, can I please have those laptop? You know, cushions because you're so low. Sorry, have gotten my husband for

Interviewer 00:15

no problem. Do you want to wait for it before we start?

Therapist 00:18

Um, here with this Thank you, darling. Or before? Thank you my love, good. Okay.

Interviewer 00:29

All right talking about quality relationship. All right. And to start with as well, I just wanted to get a better sense of your clinical practice as well. Can you clarify for me [participant], what specific modality you primarily provide in couples therapy?

Therapist 00:47

You mean modality in terms of ICBT? or trauma?

Interviewer 00:51

Exactly. That's right.

Therapist 00:54

Let me come to you what my professor long ago said when I was taking skirts, and he said, you know, if people ask you or if you're unemployed, or union and all that, I should say, Oh, he didn't say I shouldn't say but I picked up on that. I'm home Shun. So I pick up stuff that I think will relate to the polls on and sometimes if it feels well, trauma base, actually, Jung and Freud have a lot to say about childhood. And I don't know if it's Freud or not, and how, you know, when you're very young, you cannot articulate these things. So it seems more embedded on you or more difficult to deal with. And of course, now, I guess, in the last one, in the last 2040 years, neuroscience has helped and neuroplasticity has helped a lot in terms of dealing with trauma. And I know we're focusing on relationships and not in trauma, but a lot of times trauma that may have affected you when you were young may have may affect you with your relationships. And I was gonna tell you something else. But shoot, I forgot. I totally love trauma trauma. Yeah, I am so excited about neuroplasticity. Because Oh, yes, yes. And he's flavor of the month. But despite that, very, very darling, what's his name, one vessel, Abba Brasil or Bessel? Van Brander cough. Okay, he wrote, I don't know how long ago 1220 years ago, I don't know, called the Body Keeps the Score. talks about how talk therapy is usually not enough. It's never enough. Especially with deep seated trauma, as I say, which might affect relationships and the quality of your relationships. And so I hope I answered your question. So those are the three things okay that schools of thought I know I hope I have read them off and have been exposed enough to the more traditional you know, see even e I would count up more traditional, you know, who helped my clients if they need that. But more and more I see that neuroplasticity vessel Vander pop thing about

body based therapy, and I am just starting to learn this and psychedelic assisted therapy because they're, they do not allow here in the [Country A], unfortunately. Okay, and this doesn't have to be confidential, I don't care what you it's very difficult, but yes, I think when we know more about it, when enough research has happened with psychedelic assisted therapy, I think it will help bypass verbal sharing from people who find it difficult to share verbally anyway, because because in a way talk therapy has you know, sort of it will an uneven playing field because in talk therapy, or you solely have to be articulate, so you will understand them and therapists have to be articulate which means usually you have to be educated. So can you imagine how many people we cannot help because of our missed training. And this is the way I feel anyway so I think psychedelic assisted therapy will help I'm sorry Lucy Lhasa sorry Aya and mental health, no artificial consent, mental health. And people are laughing the past because they How can you tell? You know, the underprivileged and the poor mommy and the younger? I know I'm digressing. You're such a viewer. Please interrupt me at any point.

Interviewer 05:02

No, this is very interesting, very interesting, don't worry about it. And in terms of getting to get a better sense of your clinical practice, as well, are there specific types of clients that you provide your services to? Are you specializing in a certain type of, in the

Therapist 05:19

past, when I just had my master's, I only dealt with sex therapy, you know, which is a school of thought, which is, you know, therapy as opposed to sexual dysfunctions, which I when I felt confident, we didn't be in [1-5] years, expanded my practice, too, because that was what I was trained in the [Country] now, when I had my masters, you know, sexual dysfunctions, you know, as I'm sure you know, would be physical manifestations of psychological problems. So you know, in what they use term very successfully, in orgasmic erectile dysfunction, etc, etc. In my master's now during my masters, and then I realized, Oh, my God, this is so My Baba who know. And so when I got my PhD here in the [Country A], in the [City A], mainly because it was much easier to get there than in up. And, you know, it was a means to an end. When I got my masters, when I got my PhD, I really focused on, you know, problems, hopefully, that would help me solve deeper issues where, you know, sex was just what the, the battlefield, but the things that caused the war was quite deeper and far broader.

Interviewer 06:45

All right, and how long have you been since the massacres with [name]? How long has that been? Practicing? Yeah.

Therapist 06:53

I'm trying to think, I think, darling, so let's say two, to make it the 29. When I was [26-30] years old, I now [41-45]. So [41-45] years, but there were times when I stopped using, or there were two things. One is what I firmly believe in also, the therapy should not be your sole basis, your sole basis for earning money. Because if you take too long to have more clients than you should, or you tend to have them last long. This I feel is you know, no matter how ethical you are, it runs through it issue basis for your income. So because I didn't want to do that, I mean, straight. I always branched out to other things. Secondly, as you can see, and so model therapy, sometimes, unless I'm very disciplined, which I like to think I am when I do therapy, to listen much, much more than you thought. It's a more difficult

thing for me to do. That will just be and where I put a lot of my effort in, in writing columns, writing books, although that's unfair, because most of the books were just compilation to columns. So I've been practicing for [41-45] years. Oh, and teaching might have one says I in graduate in [specialization]. So even if I've been doing therapy for people years, that is not straight through.

Interviewer 08:35

Makes sense. And but you currently provide your services in the [Country A]. Right, you provide your services to couples in the [Country A] as well, or does it happen? Yes.

Therapist 08:46

Couples and individuals? Yes.

Interviewer 08:48

All right. All right. So I know, of course, that there is a bound to be a broad range, but when clients don't do but it's usually the presenting issue or the reason that they seek your service.

Therapist 09:03

Well, they will guess, you know, they know the presenting problem is not almost not the real problem, right? So the presenting problem would be well, I just recently Virginis Maus Okay. Another one would be always having fights with people in the office, mainly men. Another would be this is a single woman. The first one is joined now a woman who seemed to have it all, good job, wonderful husband, but she always had an outside relationship. So that was sort of sexual non well all seem, you know, the undercurrent seems to be factual. And then a woman or two people who are very very anxious and one who's very depressed. So that's usually I do not take more than however number that was too anxious one depressed Virginis. Half a dozen. My husband is the one who, you know, so he knows if it's more than that, because fired because I'm writing the column, which I think is very good. I've got to tell you what all of you so you

Interviewer 10:27

can read it. Definitely. All right. And I know you said that in your email whenever you earlier ebooks, you said that you didn't use any skills that you didn't use and formal assessments pen and paper. You don't use pen and paper. That's a formula. No, ever since ever, during your junior practice, you've never used

Therapist 10:53

ones I used it for, for a couple of cross cultural no [Nationality B] man or I don't know what English speaking person married to a [Nationality A] not to articulate in English, which was widely and most of the time we conversed in that language, because I could sense and before again, the stress, whenever I spoke in [language], he would get agitated as though we were colluding, you know, against them not. And he made it clear that he unfortunately, that he was paying for the therapy. And again, which sometimes happens because of our economic situation here. He was supporting the entire family, you know, so I'm sorry. So that I use the paper pencil test a very simple I'm embarrassed to say very much about this, because I thought it would jumpstart conversations, especially with her, and that was merely Gary Chapman's five love languages, you know, but I don't use I don't know what the paper pencil test

for other things like we all do I just like that. Eventually I etcetera, but the one month friendships and all that if there are some, I do not use sometimes I use Beck's inventory, often question inventory. But very rarely what I might do is remember some things and ask the client because it tends to overwhelm the client. Someone who thinks that the lead Philippi not speaking.

Interviewer 12:42

Why not? Why not to the pharmacist? Why have I never? Why was it never part of

Therapist 12:47

you know, this is awful of me. And I know you are very bright. And I'm glad you are. Because when I This is awful. I really wanted somebody else. But actually, I still see that for me, I've seen the difference between psychometricians. And psychologists clinical psychologist, and a lot of times, and I know you're in measurement, and I know you are not like this. A lot of times they're like accountants, which is you know, even with the use of the PAP and Rorschach, which are the older projective tests, you know, me who has not made it my career or my focus of intelligence, or you know, energy, I can interpret better than they and I'm sure I'm making a bomb ever means I would be very happy to learn new ways, hopefully when you're not doing this research, new things that they have, you know, where I would learn and I would be happy to teach other people

Interviewer 13:58

are okay, so you feel like you can interpret better than a man for example, that psychometricians

Therapist 14:08

I could be wrong.

Interviewer 14:09

Hmm. So when I was trying to I'm trying to get like a better sense. So when clients come to you, for example, like house? Of course there's no like pen and paper assessment, right. So is it more of a intake interview is there like an intake interview or a joint session, a single session, for example of how you get to know their problems.

Therapist 14:36

If the couple comes together, which is my own personal clinical experience, they don't necessarily in fact, more often than not, they come alone. Come so I get the basic demographics, age, blah, blah, blah, we've been married educational status, what do you do? Are you a housewife? When did you stop? And then and I don't I Ask them that at first because I don't want it to be formal. All I say is, you know, they're usually shy, you know, I don't know how to start or what, you know, start wherever you feel comfortable, don't worry, we have lots of time. And then while they're telling the story, then I get a few things, you know, how old they are, and all that. A therapy even now, it's not something that accepted in this country, I think very many people are nervous. All that. So I feel I could be wrong, that not having a particular set of questions, helps them become more relaxed. And, you know, I write down the important points. I don't forget, because sometimes I have clients that I haven't seen in three, four years. Many times, they don't know what the forums and I might mention anything. And they might they usually say, how do you remember that? You know, because, you know, they'll forget? Well, maybe

that's one of the few things I was blessed with maybe a memory that was sleeves that people tell me, not necessarily photographic. But, you know.

Interviewer 16:20

All right. That's amazing. All right. On the other talk as well, though, across the years, of course, and I think I mentioned this in the email, across the years, different therapists and different researchers have characterized the construct of relationship quality, quite differently from each other. I wanted to get your view about it for you, what is relationship quality?

Therapist 16:44

And you know, to put it very simply, relationship quality is when you do not keep secrets from each other. I could go further. I mean, because I find that a lot of these theories. I mean, I read been reading Terry rial, I forget what he calls his therapy as therapy, or E. L. He was the the first book we came out with is, I don't want to talk about it many years ago, it was about males actually having depression, except they express it in different ways, you know, fighting aggression, alcoholism. And that was a new thing 20 30 years ago, so I never forgot his name. So when he, I like what he says, That guy or there are some others, but I find to make it very simple. It's when you don't keep secrets from each other a very simple theory. I think I like simple theories, because it's also easy to explain it to the clients. And it's simple enough that you can deal with it, and habit fit special circumstances. And Sternberg triangular theory of love talks about three important points, passion, commitment, and intimacy. And I like to say in the end, if you look at it, you know, sex is relatively easy, you know, if you focus which of course people don't, if you focus on the, you know, calisthenics etc, you know, measurement, that love is hard, but the most are passionate, sorry, but the most difficult is intimacy, which is allowing yourself to be vulnerable to someone else. To me, if you can have a relationship like that, wow, it breeds all others. And part of that relationship is not having secrets from one another because one lie, you have to have other lies to support that. You know, and frankly, most of the time, not all the time, people will lie about two things. One is about affairs, which I can talk about more the other about finances, but about affairs is being patronizing when you say um, you know, I'm only not telling my partner because it will devastate him or her. And that's a big thing. Maybe you'll make the person happy and more free. Confess, confess to her own infidelity or his own infidelity. And, of course, is very difficult. It's something because how can you have a good relationship? If you're so scared, you're well, your husband or wife but usually now it's still your husband has this hanging over you that you are if you become too much of a problem he wants to

Interviewer 19:46

see you says that passion is hard, but intimacy is harder. What Why do you think other couples that have it for example, most intimate Scylla than other couples, why do you think other couples are able to be you know, are able To be more intimate with each other than the others,

Therapist 20:04

you know, I think it has to do with courage. So you take a risk you self disclose, but even that first disclosure isn't ready. Yes. Yeah. And even if your partner cannot take what you're saying, though, if your rock bottom because you trusted her, to accept you, you know, it's just that you're telling her things little by little, to have enough courage to say, well, whatever happens, even though I thought she was

the bedrock of my life, I can still, maybe, hopefully, get along. Get along live a full life a good life. In my experience, I want to ask you something and you can say no, right away. My husband and I, we sometimes do join therapy, especially when the issue I forget when that was darling, when it was not the pandemic not gonna lock down. But before financial issues getting very strong. I don't know if you want only be actually people or beat people or psychiatrists and psychologists. So those things I want, and you can say no, because, you know, I want to know if he can sometimes to remind me of something that I do, or we do. Plans. Okay.

Interviewer 21:31

That's totally okay.

Therapist 21:35

When you're making calls, for more people to interview, who are unknown, you know, feel free to interview him, darling, I hope you don't mind that my husband said he's useful in things like, personally. Yeah, there's a lot of acceptance of my alcohol works, but many times do not lovable. I mean, because of my own history, and I feel my own trauma with my family. You know, I've been married. [name] is my fourth hotspot and, and because of trauma, I never I found it very difficult to stick around and work through the relationship. If my feeling was, oh, this, this person doesn't, you know, either give a shit or it doesn't give enough time and effort, boom, I'm out of there. It was easy, because I never asked for alimony. So I would like to say no, that's not true. We husbands I divorced, four, from to stay married to them. But you know, anyway. I don't know if that helps. So I think in a relationship, part of being truthful, is not hiding your quirks, or, you know, or your, as they say, words and also your words. Because a lot of times people do it on a very superficial level. Sometimes women not all know, but a few are in or gals, because they always like to present a good thing. You're so you know, when you're older and have three children or five children. You have a bill Bill, do you know what I mean by that? Yeah. And there's some women who, when they have sex, try to suck their thumb in so that the House will not be I mean, how can you have an orgasm? If you're worried about or, you know, before the research, I like to think I've moved on to deeper things, but even at that level, in terms of intimacy, and being willing to throw yourself, you know, usually when you have an orgasm, right, your facial expression changes, you know, you maybe make sounds that you don't usually do, and some women or I say women because most men, I don't know if bless or dander hearts usually have no problem with calculation, if you want to English to like the Darwinists do, but have more difficulty. And I think that's one of the reasons in a way, it's a fear of being truly intimate, because you don't want to show your true self not because maybe he's judgmental, or he has come across as judgmental. But you're just worried that he won't accept you. You know, I mean, he doesn't have to regimental you just have rejected those feelings on him. Or, yeah,

Interviewer 24:42

super interesting. So in your professional experience the most for example, I'm trying to do to see the difference for example, between couples who who are intimate with each other, like who has like a high intimacy level for those that are low intimacy level. Like who In your professional experience, what are the most important things in a, in an intimate in the high quality in an intimate relationship? You said earlier courage are the thing, okay, for that kind of relationship? Yeah.

Therapist 25:16

Let me see. Medication if you have a mental I'm bipolar, no. So I think if I love my husband enough, it was my husband and my daughter, who finally convinced me to take medication, you know, because you know, where at least my maybe unluckily that my bipolarity had to do with hypomanic episodes, which were fantastic. Right. But of course, I was sexually promiscuous, which you love helping a marriage. But anyway, going back, I think about okay, courage, I think it's a certain amount of humility, you know, that, you know, this person is valuable to you, you can't just expect that you're so lovable, that he love you, you have to work on the relationship. So some humility. So in the beginning, when I took medication, I finally found the cocktail that worked. My [Nationality B] psychiatrists, we worked it out. In the beginning, the side effects were not that good. But I had faith in him. And I had faith in the research, which I looked, you know, looked into. And finally it worked, I guess, after what, and I haven't been having a crippling depression. Okay, I'll tell you what my husband said. But going back to being a humility is realizing that there are some things you have to do for me, I think, one of the most difficult because if you're bipolar, Maya Bunkai. things, you know, especially when you're hypomanic, it was saying yes, if I want this relationship to work, if this guy is important to me, and this is, you know, it has to you know, I have to take medication number two, so courage, humility. Maybe it's quite of humility, but it's creativity or an open mind. So there are things you see, at least for me, this was important that you wouldn't see in any other man. And that's why it's worth the long slog. It's worth, you know, sometimes biting your tongue when you want to say something nasty, but saying how you feel after you bite your tongue when you want to say you're a prick. But, but later you say, you know, I was really angry at you, you know? But, you know, all these words that mean nothing, you know, no, no. Okay, so there I think, you know, my husband is pretty bright. And, you know, I might have been, but I really like to think it's based on fat, not Oh, I really like to think, okay, he is, among my three husbands among my four husbands, who are you feel is as intelligent as me or if not more, so. So it was wonderful, because I'll tell you what, the I never got mother from another husband or another man. If we're talking and then his logic appeals to me. Okay, I got it, you've convinced me that he that's the same and me very few people do that. And I don't think we could believe within each other because our previous spouses, he has been married once before I have been married as I say three times because he was more [religion] than me then. But um, you know, at that, for me, it's such a big boulders, he has more, but the others didn't. I mean, I'll tell you about my third doubts been just to show and he's very sophisticated about things. My third husband he was well read but he was an aircraft mechanic. So when a instead of a PhD, which you can see the difference, unfortunately, but he was bright, but he was not that sophisticated. So that when when I was in the [Country] then so you know, whatever insurance paid for my medication, and once I wanted to go to get my medication, he knew I was taking medication but this was six months after and he asked me when I brought it home you still thinking that ship? You the relationship was over? I don't think you marry a man who thinks that way. Sorry, water. I have no problem. Okay, so, so what makes a relationship God? No. But I will tell you so I think courage, humility and open mindedness. So you can see. I don't know, wonder and charm, despite the fact of having met so many men or so many women, and liking them and falling in love with them, but this, this guy is for keeps this guy is a keeper. So many things. And also, I think, a sense of integrity. Many times, especially when it comes to, especially when it comes to the political situation we've had, you know, someone feels a few I mean, this is very, very My Baba. But when, during my hate day when practically everybody you knew me and I had the TV show when a column and arranger show and everything to political parties asked me to run for Senator slope. Of course, I was flattered. I said no way. Because

first of all, you will be corrupted no matter how good you are, you know, what does that saying? If you sleep with dogs, you'll inevitably get fleas. And you don't use that money. It's not that important. You know, so I think a certain sense of unknown integrity of the kind that's important to me, and values. You know, when I would say when I thought my siblings stole my inheritance objectively, what do you call them? operational definition. They didn't, they have much more money from my parents, and I have none. But anyway, when they did that, it upset me so much, mainly because I could not give my daughter I could not help her, get the kind of education she wanted to give her kids so much. And it was my husband who said, you know, it's only money. It's only money, and he was the one who just walk away from it. Because if you I didn't want to go to court, it was risky that you win all that. And I am so thankful to him for saying that. And so is that a sense of values that is even different from integrity? I think. And then just to show how smart I think he is, he wrote to me and said, when you asked about intimacy, and what I may have learned from my clients, he said, but don't forget that people couples who have intimacy are less likely to come to you as clients, because the intimacy that I doesn't solve all your problems, but helps a lot. And the one problem I think it doesn't solve, and I will quote someone because it's not original, is how can you keep sex? If not as exciting, exciting after you've been married for so long? You know, it that's difficult, and I think no matter how sexy you are, and you know, no matter how well you connect, and all that you've been married several years, sometimes even five, sometimes even two, you know, you get tempted by other people. So it can be a grit your teeth commitment to the marriage, which isn't much fun. You know. I know a guy who learned never to compliment a pretty woman, although his wife had the sort of feral intelligence, and could always tell when he was trapped. So what he learned to do to live with this is to always criticize a pretty woman. Uh, yeah, but she doesn't know how to think you see how fat her legs were the Gill, because it was the only thing the way to stop anyway. I don't. Oh, yeah. So it is very, very hard to be generous people to other women. I mean, for me, no, no, but I learned I trained myself. And that's why we bright I think and humble. Actually myself, though. You know, oh god, she's prettier. Her breasts are more PERT and her glutes can crack walnuts the way mine used to do [11-15] years ago. You know, that's life and my husband Bless his heart when I tell him that will say it's not as though you're the only one got older so am I. But the fact of the matter is, it's it's a sexist world and are far more attractive than older women. But in that sense, I'm very very lucky. I hope you're not lying to me ha like that guy lied. nasty things about pretty women. But anyway, so because Oh yeah, yeah, another quality. I think it's niceness and courage. Because, you know, if you have a woman or a man who's always so critical of other women, even he or maybe you're jealous or you wish, you know, it's no fun to be married to that sort of women to that sort of woman, I mean, you hope that you will be better in some way with your relationship. Now, richer or more famous or anything, but, you know, can live life with a more generous attitude, you know, all sentient beings. But if you have someone who looks at everyone, like a potential competitor, anyway,

Interviewer 36:02

all right, make sense? And very interesting. But other different types as well don't merge, I wanted to ask this. Because if we were saying, right, like for your relationship quality really is about intimacy. It's about, you know, when you do not keep secrets from each other. That's how you conceptualize relationships often differ from how your clients conceptualize relationships. And this is impact therapy.

Therapist 36:31

I never give them a fury, or my views of what makes a good relationship. So I hope then that that's not impact if they feel so differently. From things. I read you something I learned. So maybe this is formulae, like to agree maybe not the first session, but definitely by the third, if not the second, like to agree on what the goals for therapy are. So you know, maybe someone just wants to Oh, yeah, I want to move on. Because my husband has formed around so many times. And this last time, I found it hard to move on, because he had an actual relationship with her. Okay, so you can say, okay, there are things you can do thought stopping, you know, you can look at this as an obsessive compulsive behavior. But But, but it's this really want what you want to do just to move on or later when talking. You know, How sure are you that he won't fool around again, which is not wanting to be suspicious, but I don't want her to have a goal, which is meaningless. Because then every time she realizes he has another affair, she has felt herself to move on. So in that sense, I might suggest a different goal. Hopefully, more sadly, but but in the end, because I don't believe in manipulate them that much. But in the end, talk about what it is, you know, I will not maybe ask, because that's not what they want for the relationship to be more intimate. Because they didn't really come in to say, how can we make our relationship more intimate? How can we make our relationship more happy? Maybe How can we stop fighting with each other? You know, there are so many ways you can stop fighting with each other, that doesn't necessarily make you more intimate, it may give you a more peaceful relationship. It may make your your children more happy at that level. So when just in case it reaches that level, that's fairly easy, right? Rather than a messy, then you ask, but Okay, Doc, I think we're good. Thank you. Okay. I just want to ask you, though, just throw it back. Would you feel like you want to go with another level, either now or in the future? You know, about the cessation of war, a truce, you know, maybe you want to go deeper than that, because I might even say you want to live the rest of your life, the rest of your marriage with the truth, rather than waking up in the morning and being so excited about what you can do with your spouse or what you can both learn. You know,

Interviewer 39:33

that made sense. And so

Therapist 39:36

once of the different goals I hope I answered your question it's okay,

Interviewer 39:47

Andre, done ready. I wanted to ask you as well good we know that the relationship is a complex system, right. It involves love identity, intimacy, sex, relationship maintenance. Yeah, conflicts, all of that. During therapy, how do you decide which one to focus on? Like, which one in this complex system to target?

Therapist 40:09

Okay. Well, I decide that level the, I'm sorry, in the sense that, of course, you know, they talk about the art and science of therapy, and the science, you know, you can do measurements, which I think are very important. You can follow rules, don't keep interrupting your client, don't talk about your personal life, et cetera, et cetera. No, don't give examples if they don't need it. I mean, this is one for me, I have to remind myself constantly of because you also respect your client's intelligence, or level of understanding, you know, that if you say something that they can understand, but I think the art of

therapy is when you can recognize, okay, this person has three issues, the third is very deep. And the person in the end may be too defensive to deal with this in our therapy agreement of what the goals might be. The first is simple, it will reassure her. And the middle, I just have to see how she responds or he responds, responds to the first issue I bring up. So I guess that's how I decide, you know, parang, Surya, Jana. It's like the way self disclosure is a dance. For me, I feel therapy is also a dance, before you go somewhere really deep or some someplace that may be threatening to a client, you try and go, you know, a little bit, because she also trusts you. If it's scary. She will only stay if she trusts you. You know, so, yeah.

Interviewer 41:59

All right. So earlier, we're talking about treatment goals. How do you determine when to end a couple of therapy?

Therapist 42:09

When a lot of times, because they don't want to stop? Yeah. Because it's comfortable after a while, it's like having a friend. So in fact, sometimes I might say, okay, you know, Harvard research, I'm sure many other research, but it was the longest, it is the longest developmental study, you know, on human development, 75 years and counting. And when they talk about long life, they say by the time you're 50, based on the research, they can tell if you live till you're 80, still your 80s. And amazingly, the critical factor is not your cholesterol level, your whether you had cancer towards three times or etc, etc. It's the quality of your relationships. Okay, so they want to end Fine, then I'll say, Oh, they don't want to end you know, I'll say, Listen, remember, we agreed that this is what, you know, we decided on? So what do you feel? You know, I might even say, I feel we've dealt with it. How do you feel? And some might say no, no, no, because I want to? Or can we have one last session to tie it up? Or maybe one more month? Let's see, we're okay, that's fine. So or they may they tell you in so many ways, but I find [Nationality A] they find it hard to initiate coordination I find. So, you know, usually I have to bring it up for him. So is there anything else? And I might laugh and say, you know, all this is very interesting. But, you know, on the money, it's only tangentially related to your problems. So what do you think? Now? Do you think you know, you're about ready to take off on your own?

Interviewer 43:58

And I know, again, there's bound to be a broad range, but typically from start to finish, how many sessions or how long does that usually take?

Therapist 44:06

broad range? eight sessions, minimum, X, unless the problem is so so simple, that usually I refer these clients to other therapists, I don't want to deal with it anymore. You know, I would say a Bynum of eight to 10 sessions, maybe 10 to 30

Interviewer 44:32

or 30. And how often are these shirts? I visit every week? Once a week,

Therapist 44:38

and some if you want to pick we're off would be once every two weeks. Usually later on when they feel they can deal with it. You know, in this is my view, I'm not so sure if certainly not backed up by any research I know. But [Nationality A] still haven't accepted going to therapy. Be. So usually by the time they go to therapy, it's really been hurting, it's been hurting. So in the beginning, they have to see you at least once a week. They mean, and sometimes they want a double session, which I say no to. Because it's tiring for them mainly, I may do one and a half, especially for intake. But you know, the first session,

Interviewer 45:26

how long are the sessions? Are 1.5 I

Therapist 45:30

always tell my husband 50 minutes? Because, you know, usually they always look at to see, oh, is it an hour? Am I getting my money's worth? So, so right at the start, if they know, it's 50 minutes per session, it helps. Of course, I hardly ever do that it's usually an hour. So my husband Bless his heart is upstairs, because I have my sessions at home. You know, because, you know, I don't think you know, with eight clients. Yeah, it's not worth renting an office as far as I'm concerned. So, you know, he's upstairs, you know, so he can't appear at all, they know that he just comes out when he says, it's 10 to nine. Okay, and then can you tell me when it's five to nine, when we should? You know, have that for sure.

Interviewer 46:25

All right. So as I said, in my email, as well, we are currently developing a relationship quality scale that hopefully better represents their relationship as a complex system that aims to help therapists in treatment planning and achievement evaluation. And you said you were, you know, quite interested in the scale. But one thing that we I really want to do, of course, is that it's really not It shouldn't have clinical utility qatanani I like it should be cross culturally generalizable, it should be valid, but most importantly, it should, you know, be it should be useful. So, personally, or professionally, what would you be looking for in a newly developed relationship skill? Like, how can we make sure that this game will be useful in your practice?

Therapist 47:18

You won't agree with me, but it cannot just be a pick off multiple choice paper pencil. I think you have to ask a few essay questions. I think it's very important. Because you have to know where they're coming from its relationship, you want it to help you do therapy, right? Isn't that what the scale is? Yeah, I think it will have to have a few essay questions. That's the basic point. And then later, and by the way, I get tired very easily. So if you don't mind, we'll stop after we'll talk for 10 15 minutes more. And then if you want to have another interview, we can. But anyway, I get tired very easily. And this is related to this thing. You know, I will be very happy to talk to you about this again. Because I would like you to tell me more about it even on, it can be personal, I promise that to tell anyone, I hope you will allow me to tell my house. Because as I say test construction has never been my thing. I respect test construction, I would advise my daughter to be a psychometrician. Okay. I would love to know. So if you want to ask me more questions. I mean, I know my answer is so simple. No, don't have objective tests, have essay questions. And if you can have a certain kind of projective test, that's an essay questions, you're still cognitive there in the bar, I think it would help. You know, in the end, maybe I would tell the clinician

who will see clients and read the results, never never to confront them with the results. You know, like, say You thought you're saying this now, but actually, what you're, you know, to try and I don't know, that matters, you know, maybe so. But anyway,

Interviewer 49:32

all right. And we are planning to carefully develop and validate this scale over the course of two or three more years after this. Okay. Until, but of course, one of the things that we're thinking about is that to recoup the development costs, there will need to be a certain amount of price for the scale. I was wondering. I was wondering if you had insights on like, what is a [Nationality A] budget for this type of scale? Like what would your relationship therapists?

[Portion Redacted]

Interviewer 53:26

yeah. But we both actually just for Robinhood. So like, people, countries, you know what the more so it would be subsidized. telega Yeah, yeah. [Country A] in the book. Large Yeah, not much. I know you're already helping in the development of the scale to this interview. But I wanted to ask as well would you be interested in further collaboration for the development of this?

Therapist 53:55

I would love it. And in fact, because you seem serious, right? And I looked Of course, your website and everything I would like for you to give me readings or I will ask my friend to know more because you know, I don't think my clinical experiences enough, but I love them. All right, without proper training.

Interviewer 54:24

Actually, what would be if ever you're interested, my aim is that once we develop the scale, once we have the final version, then we can send it to you and ask for your feedback is it's good it's okay. If if you're still practicing, then that's well. What we can do is that after we've finished the validation of the scale that we can give it to you and then like for six months and then like leave after six months will ask you like what worked but then yes, and no, I No, like we're just wrapping up. We want to be considerate of your time as well. So I just want to review what we've gone over our session. So I wanted to get a better sense of your clinical practice at first and you said that you were very, you know, athletic. It was trauma based. It was also based, for example, your Metroid, neuroplasticity as well. Brasil, Vandergrift, I believe how the body keeps score, and you're interested as well as psychedelic assisted

Therapist 55:29

cycle. Yeah, never have done that. Never have done that. Right. Okay.

Interviewer 55:34

You've been a couple therapists for [41-45] years now starting therapy.

Therapist 55:40

I think you would say that, but it was more individual therapy than couples therapy. Usually husbands are not willing to come especially if the reason is that they were caught having an affair

Interviewer 55:56

are starting out with sex therapy and then moving on to other kinds of relationships. When clients come to you they usually presenting issue is well a bunch of things. It can be like always having fights, you know, affairs outside the relationship. They actually they're the rest. But of course, as we both know, it's usually not the underlying issue. Issue. You don't do formal assessments. You did once upon a time Gary Chapman's five love languages, but

Therapist 56:26

that was only one client. Yes, yes. Yeah, and, and the pale. And I'll tell you why. Also relevant up relatively early in my career. Someone told me I had a client, brilliant guy, and I'm not sure but most of my clients tend to be very bright, you know. So anyway, he said, he went to the farm, and I'm sure if you want your research to be broad base, you will have to ask the patient family, whatever movement, you know, there, is there. And he said, all they gave us was such stupid tests. And then they interpreted the results, which are nothing. And I think this is one reason I have usefully a test like that would jump start, if like, as I say, this one was our very unsophisticated, naive, [Nationality A], yes,

Husband 57:26

I got corrupt here to say, as a highly informed client, I would consider anything but the cursory use forms, eating an attempt to generalize what I want to be individual therapy. I don't want to be, you know, one of 10,000 people filling in a form I want, I want my therapist to hear what I have to say, which is different from anybody else. I feel that very strongly, particularly, if I'm paying \$200 an hour. For my therapist, I get free therapy 24/7 back how much they are dismayed without asking for it.

Interviewer 58:23

There's no chance, you

Therapist 58:28

know, but that's the best, you know, I don't think it should make them feel like it's added value, because that they have to pay for, in fact, I was thinking during intake, you would say if they could just answer maybe the paper pencil objective them and say, Look, do you think you could take this home, so they know it's not taken out of there, 50 minute, hour or whatever, really help us and, you know, confidential, and this is not, it is just to help us understand with the culture or something, as opposed to, as Jeremy says, to help us understand you. So we won't question. So we'll feel that we understand you without having gotten to.

Interviewer 59:16

Interesting, interesting. All right. And part of the reason as well that you said earlier about not you know like not I can scale. So not using scales in practice is that not having a scale helps them more relaxed as well.

Therapist 59:32

So not using these things, that's an agitated exam. Either they feel they're losing by doing this, you know, scale moves fall or you know, the cone. But the other thing is sometimes, you know, people who

are not used to giving their views, the mere fact that they answer this test, which means they are giving their views helps them

Interviewer 59:59

all right. If and when we went to a relationship quality for you with a very clear directive is when you do not keep secrets from each other. And then we talked about, for example, that that simple conceptualization can also go into, for example, Sternberg triangular theory of love. We said that love is hard or passionate hard, but being intimate is more, more difficult. And when you ask the most sure,

Therapist 1:00:25

I said sex is easy. Oh, sex or sex can be easy. Love, or passion is high. Intimacy.

Interviewer 1:00:41

Changing it?

Therapist 1:00:43

Because as I say, especially if sex is some Ababa, you know, calisthenics, how many rounds you do with us? A lot of [Nationality A], how many minutes do you last and all that? That's easy. You know?

Interviewer 1:00:59

So when we ask like, the important things in our intimate relationship with talking about courage, you were talking about humility, for example, including taking medication as medication, you're talking about open mindedness that you know, despite the many men before this, many women, you find the wonder you find the charm. And you're talking about a sense of integrity and values as well. And other personality traits such as Sanatana. As Yeah, that's right. Nice. Yes. And you were talking about niceness and time, as well. Yeah. And when you talk with doctors or talked about whether your conceptualization of relationships differ from your clients get supplementation, and for you, it's really more about taking cue of what they want their achievement goals. For example, it might not be that they want to be more intimate or want to be more happy, it can just be like, let's stop fighting. Let's go to a truth. Yeah, and talking about the complex system for you. It's also got level, you know, there's a science to it, there's principles there, but for you, at the end of the day, is really the art of therapy, you know, the barriers. As a therapist, for you, it's eight to 10 sessions, minimum, maybe 30. From the start to the termination of therapy, generally, once every two weeks, or when you taper off once once or whatever week or once you taper off once every two weeks for just one. And when we talked about the scale development for it's just cannot just be an objective test it needs, you know, it needs to have an essay question, you know, to know where they're coming from maybe a projective test as well. And talking about pricey as well. Anything you'd like to add to that?

Therapist 1:02:50

Sorry, I just thought about the projective test. It might even be something that isn't really effective test, but that you'd measure is how the people responded to it, and who are glad it was or whatever. So you get to see things like his wanting to please how strong is this need to please? how strong the three use anger as a defense mechanism or criticism? With the so called projective test,

Interviewer 1:03:23

interesting. All right. Okay, now, before we end, of course, as a research project, I'd like to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project of growth we want to be as open as ethically possible, as verifiable so I wanted to know which data sharing option you're more comfortable with. One option is that transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. Okay, another option if we were bolder, is that the whole transcript can be shared removed of sensitive and overly identified details. So it will be anonymized. Although in this option, there is a chance that people who know you professionally well, can piece together the details and narrow it down to who they believe. Yeah, of growth. We can talk about if neither of these options are comfortable with you, we can discuss that but of the which one are you are?

Therapist 1:04:22

Well, I have to tell you the answer right now my view is to go with the second option, knowing that no secrets at all what can they do to me? But number two, I want to ask my husband number three, I promise you I will not add things to the transcript to sound more intelligent. But is there something I can add? Can I add something that I may have thought important that you didn't mention? Like you know, aside from the sex is easy, love is hard. You said something but it didn't seem that big a point So I just let it go. I mean, you said things that I thought I should have added a sentence of verify. So if I do number two, would I be able to see the transparency?

Interviewer 1:05:13

Definitely. Definitely. I will be sending you the transcript that will also give me a chance to read that question with you after that. Okay. That's

Therapist 1:05:24

okay. Is that okay? Anyway? Oh, anyway, so in effect, [name] said, He will send up the transcript. So we can see we're comfortable with it. And yeah, and then later, my view is it can be completely anonymous portions of the transcript, or it will still be anonymous, the whole transcript. And so there will be several people I would think many in the [Country A] who would know that it's from me. I don't care. But anyway, we'll read it. We'll talk about it and MCs will talk to us. Was it accurate? What what I told them?

Interviewer 1:06:02

That's right. Very, very well summarized. Okay. All right. I think

Therapist 1:06:08

yeah, I'm so sorry. So long. No, no, no, no.